

SERVING A NEW COMMUNITY

The railway enterprise that emerged post-Independence broke away from the legacy of its past. Rising from the ashes of Partition and its aftermath, it had new vigour and was dedicated to provide people what they deserved. Not just a symbol of growth and modernization, the railways had become a way of life for millions.



▲ **The number of passengers** using the railways kept soaring after Independence and the Indian Railways strived to improve facilities.

During the colonial rule, railway management was controlled entirely by the British. It was only post-World War I that Indians started occupying administrative positions, limited to those in the middle level. "One of the greatest changes post-1947," Canadian historian Ian J Kerr in his 2006 book *Engines of Change* notes, "was the complete